

DEVIANCE

Sociologists define deviance as behavior that is recognized as violating expected rules and norms. Deviance is more than simple nonconformity; it is behavior that departs significantly from social expectations. In the sociological perspective on deviance, there are four main identifying characteristics:

- Deviance emerges in a social context, not just the behavior of individuals; sociologists see deviance in terms of group processes and judgments.
- Not all behaviors are judged similarly by all groups; what is deviant to one group may be normative (not deviant) to another.
- Established rules and norms are socially created, not just morally decided or individually imposed.
- Deviance lies not just in behavior itself but in the social responses of groups to behavior by others.

Sociologists distinguish two types of deviance: formal and informal.

Formal deviance: It is behavior that breaks laws or official rules. Crime is an example. There are formal sanctions against formal deviance, such as imprisonment and fines.

Informal deviance: It is behavior that violates customary norms. Although such deviance may not be specified in law, it is judged to be deviant by those who uphold the society's norms.

Meaning of Deviance

Deviance is violation of norms. It is breaking the norms of society, social manners and code of conduct in business and mutual agreements between the parties. It is against the social manners of family and marriage. It is the breaking of promise and breaking the law of state like committing crimes. Any violation of norm is Deviance. It is natural that man deviates from norms. This deviation when grows serious it is a problem. If it is ordinary there is no problem. Hundred percent control on behavior of man is impossible.

Definitions

1. **Horton and Hunt define:** "It is any failure to conform to customary norms".
2. **Louise Weston says:** "Behavior that is contrary to the standards of conduct or social expectations of a given group or society".
3. **Ian Robertson mentioned Deviance as:** "behavior that violates significant social norms and is disapproved by large numbers of people as result".

Examples: killing somebody, telling a lie, braking traffic roles, abusing, disobeying parents, violation of religious norms and social customs.

Causes of Deviance in Society

Following are the main causes of deviance in our society.

Broken Family and Improper Socialization

Family is the first institution teaching norms of social life. Parents and Siblings play important role in this process to socialize their members of family. Due to absence of both or one of the parents because of death or other reason, the child fails to get proper learning, required affection and 'needs satisfaction' in the family. He becomes disturbed emotionally and seeks protection in the company of others outside the family.

Lack of Religious Education and Morality

Religious education of the Holy Quran and the Sunnah create moral values in the individual. Manners of social life based on good and bad, right and wrong develop during social relations in the religious institutions. Norms of good conduct forbid man from wrong doings.

Lack of Basic Facilities

Humans strive for attaining peace and ease in social life. This objective is achieved through having basic facilities i.e. balanced diet, electricity, gas, telephone, better health opportunity, schooling of children etc. There are many who use wrong ways like crime, robbery, theft, dacoit, selling of drugs just to have access to modern facilities. This desire to have facilities at any cost causes social deviance.

Misuse of Mass Media

Mass media is the main force of making public opinion and socializing people. We get guidance from it in every walks of life. Negative use of it is harmful for youth and especially for teenagers. Usually, those teenagers and young man who misuse it are found in drug addiction, immoral and unethical activities. Teenagers learns new techniques of crime from movies, dramas and other related programs.

Urban Slums

Criminologists in their researches have proved that urban slums and narrow gorges are also sanctuaries of social deviance and crime.

Racial and Class inequality:

Inequalities in the class and races may also cause among the citizens. Such inequalities may even lead towards rebellion against the state.

Deviants:

Deviants are those people who violate the norms and rules of society. People usually react negatively against such violations.

Social Control

Social control is the basic mean of social solidarity and conformity. Every society or group develops its mechanism for making its members to obey the norms for the smooth functioning of society. These are the attempts of society to regulate people's thoughts and behavior. This process, may be formal or informal, is referred to as *social control*. Hence all the patterns and mechanism through which society maintains social order and cohesion is called social control.

Social control, within sociology, refers to the many ways in which our behavior, thoughts, and appearance are regulated by the norms, rules, laws, and social structures of society.

Meaning of Social Control

It means to bring people of society within the limits and compel them to adopt conformity to social norms.

Definition of Social Control

According to Fairchild, It is the process which helps a society to secure conformity to individuals as well as groups.

Horton & Hunt says that social control is a complete process where a society provides security to its members and conformity to their prospects.

Mannheim says, it is the collection of methods which can help to influence human behavior to retain social order.

It is very clear that it stops deviation to social norms and bring control and conformity in a society. It is the collective behavior through which the process of social order remains constant.

Types of Social Control

Social control tends to take one of two different forms: informal or formal.

1. **Informal social control** refers to our conformity to the norms and values of the society, and adoption of a particular belief system, which we learn through the process of socialization.
 - a. This form of social control is enforced by family, primary caregivers, peers, other authority figures like coaches and teachers, and by colleagues.
 - b. Informal social control is enforced by rewards and sanctions. Reward often takes the form of praise or compliments, but also takes other common forms, like high marks on school work, promotions at work, and social popularity.
2. **Formal social control** is that which is produced and enforced by the state (government) and representatives of the state that enforce its laws like police, military, and other local, provincial and federal agencies.
 - a. In many cases, a simple police presence is enough to create formal social control. In others situations social control is ensured through arresting, imprisonment, fine and penalties.

Crime

Crime is one form of deviance, specifically behavior that violates particular criminal laws. Not all deviance is crime. Deviance becomes crime when it is designated by the institutions of society as violating a law or laws. Deviance is behavior that is recognized as violating rules and norms of society. Those rules may be formal laws, in which case the deviant behavior would be called crime, or informal customs or habits, in which case the deviant behavior would not be called crime.

Definitions of Crime

According to John j. Macionis “Crime is the violation of criminal laws enacted by a locality, a state, or the federal government.”

According to Merriam Webster: “an illegal act for which someone can be punished by the government *especially*: a gross violation of law.”

Another definition maybe: “An action or omission which constitutes an offence and is punishable by law.”

Types of Crime

Following are the major types of crimes, as described by many sociologists.

1. Crime against Person

These are violent or nonviolent crimes directed against people. Included in this category are murder, aggravated assault, forcible rape, and robbery. Aggravated assault is the most frequently reported personal crime.

2. Crime against Property

Such crimes involve theft of property without threat of bodily harm. These include burglary (breaking and entering), larceny (the unlawful taking of property, but without unlawful entry), auto theft, and arson. Property crimes are the most frequent criminal infractions.

3. Hate Crimes

These refer to assaults and other malicious acts (including crimes against property) motivated by various forms of social bias, including that based on race, religion, sexual orientation, ethnic/national origin, or disability. This form of crime has been increasing in recent years, especially against other sects and races.

4. Crime against Morality or Victimless Crimes

Human acts against moral and ethical values of any society are called crimes against morality. Such crimes are also called victimless crimes as there is no complainant or victim. These include illicit activities, such as gambling, illegal drug use, and prostitution, in which there is no complainant. Nonetheless, there is clearly at least some degree of victimization in such crimes: Some researchers see in many instances prostitution as containing at least one victim—the prostitute himself or herself. Enforcement of these crimes is typically not as rigorous as the enforcement of crimes against persons or property.

5. Elite and White-Collar Crime

Sociologists use the term white-collar crime to refer to criminal activities by people of high social status who commit their crimes in the context of their occupation. White-collar crime includes activities such as embezzlement (stealing funds from one's employer), involvement in illegal stock manipulations (insider trading), and a variety of violations of income tax laws, including tax evasion. Also included are manipulations of accounting practices to make one's company appear profitable, thus artificially increasing the value of the company's stock. Until very recently, white-collar crime seldom generated great concern in the public mind—far less

than the concern directed at street crime. In terms of total dollars, however, white-collar crime is even more consequential for society.

6. Organized crime

It is crime committed by structured groups typically involving the provision of illegal goods and services to others. Organized crime syndicates are typically stereotyped as the Mafia, but the term can refer to any group that exercises control over large illegal enterprises, such as the drug trade, illegal gambling, prostitution, weapons smuggling, or money laundering. These organized crime syndicates are often based on racial, ethnic, or family ties, with different groups dominating and replacing each other in different criminal “industries,”

A key concept in sociological studies of organized crime is that these industries are organized along the same lines as legitimate businesses; indeed, organized crime has taken on a corporate form. There are likely senior partners who control the profits of the business, workers who manage and provide the labor for the business, and clients who buy the services that organized crime provides, such as prostitution and drug dealing. In-depth studies of the organized crime underworld are difficult, owing to its secretive nature and dangers. As organized crime has moved into seemingly legitimate corporate organizations, it is even more difficult to trace, although some sociologists have penetrated underworld networks and provided fascinating accounts of how these crime networks are organized. Gang criminality, racketeering, syndicate crime are the major types of organized crimes.

7. Corporate Crime

Corporate crime refers to a crimes committed either by a corporation or by the individuals acting on the behalf of a corporation or other business entity. It is wrongdoing that occurs within the context of a formal organization or bureaucracy and is actually sanctioned by the norms and operating principles of the bureaucracy. This can occur within any kind of organization—corporate, educational, governmental, or religious. It exists once deviant behavior becomes institutionalized in the routine procedures of an organization. Sociological studies of corporate deviance show that this form of deviance is embedded in the ongoing and routine activities of organizations. Individuals within the organization may participate in the deviant behavior with little awareness that their behavior is illegitimate. In fact, their actions are likely to be defined as in the best interests of the organization—business as usual. New members who enter the organization learn to comply with the organizational expectations or they leave. Instead of

conceptualizing organizational deviance as merely the behavior of bad individuals, sociologists see it as the result of employees following rules and making decisions in more ordinary ways.

